



Seas and oceans



Did you know?

At its deepest point, the Marianas Trench stretches down 7 miles (11 km).



The world's oceans

There are four main oceans in the world. They cover nearly three-quarters of the Earth's surface.

From space, the Earth looks blue because most of it is covered by water. Below the waves is a secret world we are only just beginning to explore.

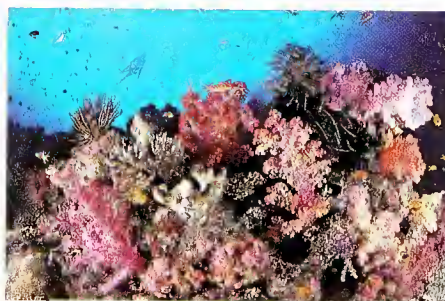


The **Arctic Ocean** is the smallest ocean. It freezes over in the winter months, and only icebreaker ships can get through.



The **Antarctic Ocean** surrounds Antarctica.

The **Indian Ocean** stretches between Africa and Australia. Coral reefs grow in the warm, shallow waters close to shore.



The **Pacific Ocean** is bigger than all the other oceans put together. It has huge waves.

The **Atlantic Ocean** separates America from Europe and Africa. Huge container ships carry cargo between the continents.



Sea exploration

Canoes were used by the first explorers. Wind and sea currents helped them move.



Spanish sailing ship

Sailing ships were used by explorers 500 years ago to sail around the world.



Submarines are used by today's explorers to study the seabed under the ocean.

The seabed

If you drained away the oceans, you'd see the seabed has valleys and mountains just like dry land.

